CHAPTER 01 | AROUND 2000-2007: FIVE DAY-SCHOOL YEARS, THEN TWO BOARDING HIGH-SCHOOL YEARS

Fiango

Football, friendship, unpaid school fees, and a gifted boy's growing determination to give his mother a better life.

Dramatic question What happens when a boy who can invent a solution to anything meets a problem he cannot talk his way out of?

Act I - Setup

Street football introduces Zino's wit, competitiveness, and temper. Luc and Gideon hear his outrageous stories about Grand-Chukuchuku, the man who achieves what nobody else can. Brief fantasy sequences make those boasts visible before returning us to the real game. The compound is a small society: two families, three single mothers, two bachelors, and three student tenants share the well and mango tree. The landlord's monthly collection of rent and electricity money turns money into a recurring presence. Zino's mother, a primary-school teacher, believes in him. His father died after a snake bite while spraying cocoa when Zino was two, so the loss enters through family history rather than a memory he owns.

Turning point: His imagination can win an argument, but the household's limits cannot be wished away.

Act II - Confrontation

The first five years of day school give Zino daily life with Luc and Gideon. His earlier primary-school fee exclusion can return as a clearly placed memory; the later high-school exclusion belongs at its actual date. Each June, the daytime vocational school called Professional School opens classrooms at night for day-school students to revise, study in groups, socialize, or escape home; show its temptations without claiming every student is distracted. Zino's four reported encounters with jungle justice occur during these Fiango years. At the end of the five years, he writes ten GCE Ordinary-Level subjects, from a possible maximum of eleven. Proud of the result, his uncle promises that Zino can choose any school and go to America if he succeeds in all five Advanced-Level subjects. Zino chooses boarding school.

Turning point: The first result turns an uncle's pride into a promise strong enough to send Zino far from home.

Act III - Consequence

The final two high-school years move Zino to a remote village reached after a day of travel through mountains and valleys. Boarding school brings elite students, rich parents, white teachers and priests, rigid routine, bullying, and discipline. Zino witnesses students punished for jumping the fence to buy food; he is not the student jumping. At the end, he writes five GCE Advanced-Level subjects, the maximum and his university study area. His school has a 100% Advanced-Level pass rate, so the radio result brings celebration rather than fear of failing. When Zino reminds his uncle about America, the uncle moves the promise: first Zino must complete a university degree.

Turning point: Zino has met the condition, but the goalpost moves and the next dream becomes a longer journey.

CHAPTER 01 | DEVELOPMENT PAGE

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Fiango

At the beginning	At ten, Zino has completed primary school and lives with his mother in Fiango.
At the end	Secondary school is complete in 2007; his ambition now depends on finding a way to continue.

Three possible short episodes

1. Grand-Chukuchuku Never Loses

A football dispute introduces the imaginary hero and the real boy's difficulty accepting an unfavorable decision.

2. School Fees

At the remembered age, a fee exclusion interrupts academic confidence and changes the rhythm of an ordinary school day.

3. The Crowd

Zino witnesses a hard-R composite of jungle justice during the Fiango day-school years: an accusation becomes public violence. The episode shows the brutality directly and ends with the fear, silence, and moral damage left behind.

4. Results on Air

The radio makes the GCE result days public. Ten Ordinary Levels bring Zino an uncle's promise of school choice and America after five Advanced Levels; the later promise is deferred until after university.

5. The Fence

Zino witnesses students punished after jumping the boarding-school fence to buy food. The episode makes clear that he does not jump, while showing how hunger, fear, and discipline shape the whole dormitory.

Memory prompts

1. What were your ten Ordinary-Level subjects at GBHS Kumba, and what is one defining school-day memory of Luc, Gideon, Elianne or Miss Mukete?

2. What exact words did your uncle use after the Ordinary Levels, and how did you decide to take him up on the boarding-school offer?

3. What did Professional School mean in your day school, which exam was it for, and what is one evening or jungle-justice incident you remember most clearly?

4. What was the boarding school's name, how did you travel there, what were your five Advanced-Level subjects, and how did your uncle explain the change to his America promise?

Grand-Chukuchuku motif Grand-Chukuchuku is playful and spectacular: imaginary victories contrast with ordinary limits.

Details still open: Ordinary Levels earn an America promise; Advanced Levels defer it until after university. Zino witnessed the fence punishments.